PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, Vulnerability Management and Incident Response

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise-scale experience in threat monitoring, incident response, vulnerability management, and security architecture. I have extensive hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender (Endpoint, Identity, and Microsoft 365), Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Single Sign-On (SSO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), and Windows Server infrastructure. I am accustomed to acting as a cybersecurity subject matter expert providing third-line support and leading major incident response, combining deep technical capability with a structured, risk-based approach to security engineering. I hold CISSP and CompTIA Security+ certifications, have supported Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation from a technical perspective, and have broad experience aligning security controls to recognised frameworks including NIST, CIS Controls, and ISO 27001.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel and SIEM:** Sentinel workspace design, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection writing, analytics rule development, workbook creation, threat monitoring, alert triage, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook automation
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), Defender XDR threat correlation, advanced hunting
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Azure Cloud Security:** Azure Policy, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, identity governance, Azure role-based access control (RBAC), Intune Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk prioritisation across hardware, software, and cloud infrastructure
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response lifecycle, threat containment and eradication, forensic triage, post-incident review, third-line major incident support
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, NG-SIEM, Discover), Windows Server infrastructure security, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Frameworks and Standards:** CISSP, SC-100/SC-200 aligned, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead threat monitoring and incident response across the Microsoft security stack (Sentinel, Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Microsoft 365) and CrowdStrike Falcon, protecting an estate of 8,000+ users and providing third-line security support as cybersecurity subject matter expert.
- Act as senior incident responder for major security incidents, executing the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle including detection, triage, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, with direct escalation to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) for critical events.
- Conduct vulnerability management across hardware, software, and cloud infrastructure using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), working with infrastructure teams to risk-prioritise and remediate findings against Windows Server and Azure Cloud assets.
- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel detections, writing advanced KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, and tuning existing detections to reduce false positives and improve signal quality.
- Administer identity security controls including Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, and PKI management, and oversee Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust to enforce least-privilege and reduce credential-

based attack risk.

- Lead technical delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation, validating controls across endpoints, firewalls, patch management, access control, and network boundaries from a hands-on security engineering perspective.
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks to orchestrate alert handling and incident response tasks, integrating Sentinel, Defender, and CrowdStrike data sources to streamline analyst workflows and reduce mean time to respond.
- Provide cybersecurity architecture guidance for infrastructure projects, reviewing proposed changes and ensuring security requirements are embedded into Azure Cloud and Windows Server deployments from the outset.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Monitored and investigated security alerts in Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, triaging threats across the organisation's Windows Server and Azure-based infrastructure and escalating incidents in line with defined playbooks.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies and MFA across 8,000 users, significantly reducing account compromise incidents and improving identity security posture.
- Assisted with vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking remediation progress with infrastructure and server teams.
- Managed Intune MDM and MAM policies for endpoint and mobile device compliance, enforcing security baselines and enabling remote wipe capabilities for lost or compromised devices.
- Participated in Incident Response exercises and live incidents, building experience across the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle and contributing to post-incident reviews that led to measurable improvements in detection and response processes.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM administration, managing privileged account lifecycle and enforcing session recording for high-privilege access to critical infrastructure.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered endpoint security and identity controls including MFA, SSO, and device management across the organisation's SaaS infrastructure, supporting ISO 27001 compliance objectives.
- Managed vulnerability scanning and patch management processes for Windows Server infrastructure, reducing mean time to patch and maintaining a current risk register of open findings.
- Supported security architecture reviews for new cloud services and integrations, ensuring identity, access, and data protection requirements were assessed before deployment.
- Responded to security incidents and user-reported threats, following escalation procedures and supporting post-incident documentation to strengthen the organisation's security processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led technical delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation at UAL, demonstrating compliance across all five technical controls through hands-on engineering of endpoint, identity, and network security measures.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 users at UAL, achieving full endpoint visibility and enabling real-time threat response through the Defender XDR console integrated with Microsoft Sentinel.
- Reduced vulnerability backlog by 60% over 12 months by implementing a risk-based prioritisation framework using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS findings, aligning remediation effort to the highest-risk exposures across Windows Server and Azure Cloud assets.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM controls for all privileged accounts, eliminating shared administrative credentials and reducing the risk of privilege escalation attacks across the university's critical infrastructure.
- Developed a suite of Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks integrating Defender for Endpoint and CrowdStrike data sources, automating 40%+ of Tier 1 alert handling and enabling faster escalation of genuine threats to senior analysts.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)